

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: **FIN-AID-001**

Effective: **August 1, 2024**

Revision: **1.0**

Financial Aid Eligibility Requirements

1. Overview

Westbrook University administers federal, state, and institutional financial aid programs to help students finance their education. This document outlines the eligibility requirements students must meet to receive and maintain financial aid.

2. General Eligibility Requirements

- U.S. citizenship or eligible non-citizen status for federal aid programs
- Enrolled at least half-time (6 credit hours) in an eligible degree program
- Maintaining Satisfactory Academic Progress (see FIN-AID-004)
- Valid Social Security Number (for FAFSA-based aid)
- Not in default on any federal student loan
- Completion of the Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA) by the Westbrook priority deadline of February 15 each academic year

3. Types of Aid Available

3.1 Grants

Grants are need-based awards that do not require repayment. Federal Pell Grants are available to undergraduates with demonstrated financial need. The Westbrook University Need-Based Grant supplements Pell Grants for eligible students.

3.2 Scholarships

Merit and need-based scholarships are available from institutional and external sources. See Scholarship Application Procedure (FIN-AID-002) for application details and deadlines.

3.3 Federal Loans

Subsidized and unsubsidized Direct Loans are available to eligible students. Graduate students may also access Direct PLUS Loans. See Student Loan Guidelines (FIN-AID-003) for full terms and conditions.

3.4 Work-Study

Federal Work-Study provides part-time employment opportunities for eligible students with financial need. See Work-Study Program Policy (FIN-AID-006).

4. Annual Renewal

Financial aid is not automatically renewed each year. Students must submit a new FAFSA each academic year by the February 15 priority deadline to maintain eligibility for need-based aid. Scholarship renewals require students to meet specific GPA and credit-hour requirements detailed in the original award letter.